



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2025-26
PRE BOARD EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

*Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.
You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.
This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.
The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.*

*Attempt all five questions.
The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].
This paper consists of five printed pages.*

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- (i) Write an original story revolving around the discovery of an old treasure chest by a boy.
- (ii) Some people love to wake up early and enjoy the calm beauty of the morning while others feel more alive and creative late at night. Which time of the day do you enjoy the most? Describe in detail what you see, hear and feel during that time and explain why it is special to you.
- (iii) “Technology has made people more connected but less compassionate.” Express your views for or against the statement.
- (iv) Narrate an incident that made you realize that courage can come from the most unexpected places.
- (v) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture, or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- (i) Write a letter to your cousin sharing with him/her how you happened to rescue an injured kitten. Write how you helped it to heal and what measures do you intend to take to ensure that it receives proper care in the days ahead.
- (ii) Write a letter to the Director of the City Zoo seeking permission for a school group visit. Give details pertaining to the number of students and teachers, the date and time of the visit and explain how this trip will be beneficial for the students.

Question 3

- (i) You are a member of the Literary Club of your school. Write a notice for your school notice board inviting students of classes VIII - X to participate in an Inter-School Poetry Writing Competition to be held at your school. [5]
- (ii) Write an e-mail to the Principal of a neighbouring school requesting him/her to send a team of two participants to participate in the event. Give necessary details. [5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

The day of Eid dawned with an air of exhilaration and expectancy for Hamid, a small, spirited boy who lived with his grandmother, Amina. Orphaned in early childhood, Hamid had been nurtured under the modest care of his grandmother, a woman of immense tenderness and quiet *fortitude*.

Hamid's father had died of cholera just the previous year and his mother turned yellow and breathed her last, untreated. Poverty struck them early in life. Though their means were limited, Hamid's heart brimmed with cheerfulness and curiosity as he prepared eagerly to accompany the other children to the fair.

Hamid had preserved three precious 'paise', earned through small, laborious tasks. As he donned his simple garments and hastened toward the fair, Amina cautioned him to guard his coins with care. The village lanes shimmered with festive life — laughter echoed through the air, melodies floated from distant stalls and the *enticing* aroma of roasted delicacies filled the breeze. Hamid's playmates darted about with colourful toys, sweets and sparklers; their mirth unrestrained. Hamid observed them with a calm fascination, untouched by envy. His joy was quieter yet far more profound. 10

As he wandered through the bustling fair, Hamid's eyes scanned the myriads of toys, confections and glittering trinkets. Yet, his mind continually drifted back to his grandmother — the weary hands that cooked for him and toiled endlessly to make their humble dwelling warm.

His gaze then fell upon a small iron stove — plain, sturdy and purposeful. In that instant, a thought blossomed within him: this would ease Amina's daily hardship. Without hesitation, he spent his three coins on the stove, foregoing the transient delights that lured his young heart. 20

Upon his return, when Hamid presented the stove, Amina's face mirrored both astonishment and tenderness. Comprehension soon softened her expression; tears glistened in her eyes as she realized her grandson's self-denial sprang from love and empathy. Hamid had renounced fleeting pleasure for enduring affection. Hamid's choice illuminated timeless truths — the grace of selflessness, the quiet grandeur of sacrifice and the moral wisdom that can dwell even in a child's heart.

For many, Eid was a day of merriment; for Hamid and Amina, it became a moment of silent moral triumph and profound emotional communion. Ultimately, the tale reminds readers that genuine happiness lies not in indulgence but in compassionate giving — that love, in its purest form, can ennoble even the simplest lives. 30

- from 'Idgah' by Munshi Premchand

(i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage): [2]

1. fortitude (line 4)

- (a) pleasure
- (b) courage
- (c) timidity
- (d) irresolution

2. enticing (line 12)

- (a) tempting
- (b) fluctuating
- (c) repulsing
- (d) gripping

(ii) Which word in the passage is the opposite of 'permanent'? [1]

- (a) foregoing
- (b) communion
- (c) grandeur
- (d) transient

(iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

- (a) How did poverty strike hard on Hamid's parents? [2]
- (b) What shows that Hamid was very excited on the day of the festival? How did he save the meagre 'three paise'? [2]
- (c) What did Hamid choose to buy over toys and other playful items? Why? [2]
- (d) Quote the sentence from the passage which tells us that Hamid was not envious of his playmates. [1]
- (e) How did Amina react when she received the gift from Hamid? [2]

(iv) In not more than 50 words, summarize how Hamid's empathy for his grandmother made him reject material happiness. [8]

Question 5

(i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. Example (0)- have discovered [4]

Scientists __0__ (discover) that spending time in nature __1__ (reduce) stress. A recent study __2__ (conduct) by experts __3__ (show) that students who take daily walks in greenery perform better in exams than those who prefer to stay indoors. Nature, therefore, __4__ (act) as a healer for the mind. Researchers have further __5__ (observe) that exposure to fresh air increases creativity and emotional balance. In many schools, teachers now __6__ (encourage) outdoor learning as they __7__ (believe) that it can help students connect theory with the real world. Indeed, the more human beings __8__ (embrace) the rhythms of nature, the more they are discovering their own sense of calm.

- (ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words: [4]
- (a) The manager insisted _____ revising the proposal before submission.
 - (b) The scientist was absorbed _____ his experiment when the lights went out.
 - (c) The poet drew inspiration _____ the serene beauty of the countryside.
 - (d) Many students are indifferent _____ the importance of time management.
 - (e) The politician was accused _____ concealing vital information.
 - (f) They set _____ a new company last year.
 - (g) The teacher was disappointed _____ the careless attitude of the class.
 - (h) The child hid _____ the bed to avoid doing his homework.

- (iii) Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using and, but or so. Choose the correct option. [4]

1. The sun set. Darkness spread over the valley.
 - (a) The sun set, so darkness spread over the valley.
 - (b) The sun set making the valley dark.
 - (c) As the sun set, darkness spread over the valley.
 - (d) Although the sun set, darkness spread over the valley.
2. The boy was very tired. He continued to play football.
 - (a) Although the boy was tired, he continued to play football.
 - (b) Although the boy was very tired, he continued to play football.
 - (c) The boy continued to play football despite of being very tired.
 - (d) The boy was tired still he played football.
3. She missed the train. She decided to wait for the next one.
 - (a) She missed the train but decided to wait for the next one.
 - (b) She missed the train only to wait for the next one.
 - (c) Having missed the train, she decided to wait for the next one.
 - (d) Missing her train, she decided to wait for the next train.
4. She does not like apples. She does not like oranges.
 - (a) Neither does she like apples nor oranges.
 - (b) Neither apples nor oranges she likes.
 - (c) Neither does she like apples nor does she like oranges.
 - (d) Neither she likes apples nor she likes oranges.

- (iv) Choose the correct option to rewrite the following according to the instructions given after each sentence. [8]

1. If you read a book regularly, your vocabulary will improve. (*Begin: Unless...*)
 - (a) Unless you do not read a book regularly, your vocabulary will not improve.
 - (b) Unless you read a book regularly, your vocabulary will not improve.
 - (c) Unless you do not read a book regularly, your vocabulary will improve.
 - (d) Unless you read a book regularly, your vocabulary will improve.
2. This is the most exciting movie I have ever seen. (*Begin: No other...*)
 - (a) No other movie I have ever seen is as exciting as this.
 - (b) No other movie is more exciting than this.
 - (c) No movie I have ever seen is more exciting than this.
 - (d) No other movie is more exciting than this that I have ever seen.

3. Although the players were exhausted, they continued the match. (*Use: Despite*)
- (a) Despite of continuing the match, the players were exhausted.
 - (b) Despite of being exhausted, the players continued the match.
 - (c) Despite continuing the match, the players were exhausted.
 - (d) Despite being exhausted, the players continued the match.
4. The girls were cleaning the drawing room. (*Begin: The drawing room...*)
- (a) The drawing room is being cleaned by the girls.
 - (b) The drawing room was cleaned by the girls.
 - (c) The drawing room were being cleaned by the girls.
 - (d) The drawing room was being cleaned by the girls.
5. She opened the window because she wanted some fresh air. (*Use: so that*)
- (a) She opened the window so that she could get fresh air.
 - (b) She opened the window so that fresh air could be got by her.
 - (c) She opened the window so that she could get some fresh air.
 - (d) She opened the window so that some fresh air could get in.
6. He is the most mischievous boy in the class. (*Add a question tag*)
- (a) He is the most mischievous boy in the class, isn't he?
 - (b) He is the most mischievous boy in the class, is he?
 - (c) He is the most mischievous boy in the class, does he?
 - (d) Is he the most mischievous boy in the class?
7. Neelam said, "It is the manager's duty to resolve the issue." (*Begin: Neelam said that...*)
- (a) Neelam said that it is the manager's duty to resolve the issue.
 - (b) Neelam said that it was the manager's duty to resolve the issue.
 - (c) Neelam said that it were the manager's duty to resolve the issue.
 - (d) Neelam said that it had been the manager's duty to resolve the issue.
8. As soon as the superstar arrived, his fans crowded around him. (*Begin: No sooner...*)
- (a) No sooner did the superstar arrive, his fans crowded around him.
 - (b) No sooner did the superstar arrive than his fans crowded around him.
 - (c) No sooner did the superstar arrived than his fans crowded around him.
 - (d) No sooner did the superstar arrive when his fans crowded around him.